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September 10, 2026

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Simon Fraser University
8888 University Drive
Burnaby, BC V5A 1S6

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the position of Assistant Professor in the Department of Economics at Simon Fraser University. I completed my Ph.D. in Economics at Toronto Metropolitan University in August 2026 and currently teach in its Department of Economics. My research lies at the intersection of macroeconomics, health economics, and public economics, combining structural theory with empirical analysis of household saving, medical spending, insurance, and wealth inequality. I am legally eligible to work in Canada under a Canadian Open Work Permit valid through 2030.

My job market paper, “Marginal Utility Shocks and the Precautionary Saving Puzzle,” documents that saving and medical spending both accelerate at the top of the wealth distribution. The paper derives a sufficient condition under which saving remains positive at arbitrarily high wealth and shows that precautionary saving alone can generate a stationary wealth distribution with Pareto tails. Calibrated to the data, the mechanism accounts for roughly 11 percent of observed saving in the top wealth decile. My broader research program studies means-tested health insurance, the health production function and longevity, mortality risk, and household saving. This work uses large household surveys, data imputation, web-scraped price data, econometrics, and quantitative modeling. These tools and questions complement SFU’s strengths in applied economics and would support collaboration across applied econometrics, public economics, and related fields.

I am equally committed to teaching. As a Contract Lecturer at Toronto Metropolitan University, I have taught introductory and intermediate macroeconomics, mathematics for economics, and economic issues in globalization. My graduate-assistant experience also includes advanced macroeconomics, mathematical economics, advanced microeconomics, and advanced financial economics at both undergraduate and graduate levels. I aim to make rigorous economic reasoning accessible through clear structure, active problem solving, and applications that connect theory to policy and data. I would welcome the opportunity to teach in SFU’s undergraduate and graduate programs and to supervise students developing applied and quantitative research skills.

SFU’s commitment to research excellence, strong applied-economics community, and emphasis on high-quality teaching make the Department an excellent home for my research and teaching agenda. Enclosed are my curriculum vitae, research and teaching statements, job market paper, teaching evaluations, and reference information. Thank you for considering my application. I would be pleased to discuss how my work could contribute to the Department of Economics at Simon Fraser University.

Sincerely,

Mohammad Amin Shirazian (Amin)